

Municipal Unit Strategic Taskforce Meeting - August 18th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QW_tjo5yZ80
Publication Date	2026-08-19T09:36:53Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Delaware County Municipal Unit Strategic Task Force (MUST) Pre-Planning Educational Session [00:09:35](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** Convened under Indiana Code § 6-3.6-3-13 following local income tax (LIT) restructuring enacted under Senate Enrolled Act (SEA) 1 and House Enrolled Act (HEA) 1210. Representatives from Baker Tilly (Paige Sansone) and Policy Analytics (Sam Ricks) presented foundational overviews of the MUST framework, the mechanics of LIT restructuring, and upcoming forecasting tools. The primary goal discussed is maintaining Delaware County's overall LIT rate at or near the current 1.5% while ensuring financial stability and whole-unit consideration for all townships, cities, and towns.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Called to order by Presiding Officer Matt Krezke, President Pro-Tempore of the Delaware County Council, serving as chair of the task force [00:09:35](#).

- **Attendance:**
 - *Voting Members Present:* Greg Wright (City Controller, Muncie), Jennifer Divine (Clerk-Treasurer, Selma), Bridget DeWise (Clerk-Treasurer, Eaton), Tracy Pittinger (Clerk-Treasurer, Gaston), Amy Roberts (Clerk-Treasurer, Daleville), and Matt Krezke (Delaware County Council Representative).
 - *Members Absent:* Representatives from Albany, Yorktown (Chase Lance noted absent initially), and Chesterfield (noted as dual-county entity).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted under the Open Door Law; noted as livestreamed on YouTube and recorded [00:10:09](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** None noted (initial pre-planning meeting).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Note: As an educational and pre-planning session, no formal ordinances, resolutions, or binding votes on tax rates or distribution formulas were scheduled or executed.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None specific to an individual voting item, as no substantive policy actions were voted upon.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal votes were taken. All structural presentations were received for informational purposes.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:05:24](#) **Resident (Unnamed):** Asked for clarification regarding the meeting referenced from earlier in the day (confirmed as a Delaware County Council special meeting on August 18th).
- [01:05:48](#) **Jason Cha (Union President, IAFF Local 1348):** Spoke regarding public safety concerns, highlighting that the Muncie Fire Department is among the busiest per capita in Indiana (18,000+ calls) but ranks 78th in pay statewide, leading to staff retention challenges compared to surrounding departments. Urged the task force to prioritize public safety in future funding structures.
- [01:18:52](#) **Rick Yenser (Resident/Author):** Expressed skepticism regarding state-level property tax caps and LIT shifts, warning that small towns and public safety units could face severe funding strains under the new framework.
- [01:21:22](#) **Dan Riden (Mayor of Muncie):** Thanked local officials for collaborating through the MUST process, noted the importance of keeping municipalities whole, and recommended that the county maximize the optional Fire and EMS rate while pushing for legislative flexibility regarding law enforcement inclusion in public safety LIT.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The next collaborative meeting is scheduled for **September 1st at 4:00 PM**.
 - Handouts and meeting recordings will be posted to the Delaware County website (delawarecounty.in.gov) and YouTube channel.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment **01:27:28** (exact time not formally stated on the record, following the 4:00 PM meeting format).

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